

TaskWA

User Manual

Everything your team needs in two pages — and everything the administrator needs in the rest.

Version 1.6 · July 2026

I For team members — the only pages you need

TaskWA sends you one WhatsApp message each morning with your open tasks. You reply in the same chat. That's the whole system.

Your morning message looks like this:

Good morning, Ravi - 3 open tasks today:

1. [HIGH] Send Q2 invoice to Alpha LLC - due Fri 17 Jul
2. Buy cement for Site B - due today
- [!] 3. Fix generator - BLOCKED 2d: waiting on supplier quote

Reply: 1 done | 1 in progress | 1 block <reason>

Replying — use the number from the list, then the word:

You send	What happens
1 done	Task 1 is closed. You get a thumbs-up reaction as confirmation.
2 in progress	Task 2 is marked started.
3 block waiting on quote	Task 3 is marked blocked with your reason, and the admin is told immediately. Always include the reason.
3 block waiting on @Priya	Same, but the block is handed to Priya: she gets one message telling her you're waiting on her, with instructions to release it.
3 unblock	You release a block that waits on YOU (your part is done, or there is no block on your side). The task flips back to in-progress and its owner is told.
1 reopen	Made a mistake? This reopens a task you closed.
done	If you have only one open task, no number is needed.

Even easier — swipe to reply. Swipe (long-press → Reply) on the task's message and just type **done**. The bot knows which task you mean.

See your list any time: send **/mytasks**. **Confused?** Send **/help**.

Creating a task

Send **/add** with a title. Mention someone to assign it to them; add **!high** or **!low** for priority; end with a date word — today, tomorrow, fri, or 25/07:

```
/add Send Q2 invoice @Priya fri !high
```

Create task: "Send Q2 invoice" -> Priya,
due Fri 17 Jul, high priority?
Reply Y to confirm, N to cancel.

Reply **y** and it's created. Nothing is created without your confirmation. In a group, the task shows up in that group's daily list; otherwise **the assignee is told immediately** (next section).

When a task is created FOR you

The moment someone assigns you a task, you get a message — no waiting for tomorrow's digest:

New task from Sudhakar: Send Q2 invoice,
due Fri 17 Jul

Reply Y to accept, N to decline
(no reply in 30 min counts as accepted).

Reply: 7 done | 7 in progress
| 7 block <reason>

Y accepts. **N** sends the task straight back to whoever created it — it never just disappears. Say nothing for 30 minutes and it counts as accepted. The number in the message (the task's permanent #) works right away.

Created it yourself? The creator keeps two powers over their own task even after it's assigned: **7 done** closes it, **7 cancel <reason>** cancels it — the assignee gets one notice either way. Everything else (starting, blocking) stays with the assignee.

Waiting on a teammate? Hand them the block

Stuck because someone else must act first? Name them with an @ and the bot runs the follow-up for you:

3 block waiting on @Priya

Priya - Ravi is waiting on you for task #3:
Fix generator
Reason: waiting on @Priya

Reply: 3 unblock - when your part is done,
or if there's no block on your side.

Priya's **3 unblock** flips the task back to in-progress and tells Ravi it's on him again. Until then her own morning digest reminds her under **Waiting on you**. She can release the block, but she cannot close Ravi's task.

Good to know: only you (or an admin) can close your tasks — a teammate can't mark your work done. The bot never reads receipts, never replies to normal conversation, and stays completely silent in chats that aren't registered.

II For the administrator

You run TaskWA from the dashboard at <http://localhost:3000> on the machine where it is installed. Log in with the admin password.

Members

Register each person with a name and their WhatsApp number (country code + number, digits only — e.g. 9715xxxxxxx). The number IS their identity: messages from any other number are ignored silently. Roles: **admin** receives blocker alerts and can update anyone's task; **member** manages only their own. Deactivating a member stops their digests and their commands instantly — reassign their open tasks first from the Tasks page.

The fast way — import from a group. Members page → **Import from group** → pick a registered group: every participant appears in a table with their name and number pre-filled. Tick the ones you want, fix names, click Import — done. Participants whose numbers WhatsApp hides (privacy settings) are shown with the remedy: save them as a contact, or make the bot's number a group admin, and re-detect.

Groups

Add the bot's WhatsApp number to the group, then click **Detect my groups** on the Groups page — every group the number belongs to appears with a one-click Register button. Only registered groups are listened to; everything else stays private. Tasks flagged 'post to group' (or created via /add inside the group) appear in that group's daily digest instead of the assignee's personal one.

Broadcasts — your own plain messages, on a schedule

Broadcasts send **exactly the text you type** to chosen members and groups — no task numbers, no headers, no reply footer. Recipients see an ordinary WhatsApp message from you. Use them for the daily good-morning, status nudges, or anything that isn't a task.

On the Broadcasts page	Notes
Message text	Sent verbatim. {date} becomes '11 July 2026', {day} becomes 'Friday'. WhatsApp *bold* and <i>_italic_</i> work.
Days + send time	Tick weekdays and set a time — or leave the time empty for a manual-only broadcast you fire with Send now.
Time zone	Each broadcast has its own timezone dropdown (defaults to the dashboard setting) and is PINNED to it when saved — changing the dashboard timezone later never moves an existing broadcast.
Recipients	Any registered members and groups. To message someone who isn't on the task team, register them as a member — with no tasks they'll never get digests, only your broadcasts.
Pacing	Recipients are messaged 20–45 seconds apart and never overlap other TaskWA sends — ban-risk hygiene. A missed send (machine off) is deliberately skipped, not delivered late.

Settings that matter

Setting	Meaning
Timezone & send times	IANA timezone (e.g. Asia/Dubai) and one or more daily digest times, comma-separated (08:00, 17:00).
Acknowledgment mode	reaction (thumbs-up on the message — recommended), reply (a text 'Noted.'), or silent.
Personal number mode	ON when the bot shares your own WhatsApp number. The bot then never replies to anything that isn't a command, your private chats are never touched, and your own digest arrives in 'Message Yourself'.
Dry-run	The safety switch: ON means every message is logged on the Health page instead of being sent. Use it whenever you experiment.
Hourly cap / retention	Upper bound on messages per hour (ban-risk hygiene) and days before completed tasks are archived to CSV and purged (default 30).

The Health page — your first stop when anything seems wrong

Status	What to do
WORKING	All good. Check 'last digest' and 'last backup' times occasionally.
SCAN_QR_CODE	The WhatsApp pairing dropped. Click Start session if needed, scan the QR with the bot number's phone (WhatsApp → Linked devices), refresh.
STARTING	Be patient — 30–60 seconds on Apple Silicon.
FAILED / STOPPED	Click Start / restart session. If it fails repeatedly, restart the gateway container (see Installation Guide, Troubleshooting).
UNREACHABLE	The gateway container isn't running — usually right after a reboot; wait a minute. Persisting: docker compose up -d from the install folder.

The message log at the bottom shows every outbound message with its status — including **dryrun** (not sent, dry-run on), **failed** (gateway error, shown), and **blocked** (recipient not registered — the allowlist refused it, which is the system protecting you).

Routine care

- **Backups are automatic** — nightly database snapshots, 14 kept, in the backups folder. To restore: stop the app, copy a snapshot over data/tasks.db, start again.
- **Exports** — tasks.csv and audit.csv from the Tasks page, any time.
- **Forgotten password** — 'Forgot password' on the login page sends a 6-digit code to your WhatsApp. If WhatsApp itself is down: docker compose exec app python -m app.cli reset-password
- **Upgrades** — see docs/UPGRADE.md; in short: git pull, docker compose up -d --build. Data survives.
- **Survive restarts automatically** — run the one-command autostart installer for your OS (scripts/autostart-macos.sh, autostart-windows.ps1, sudo autostart-linux.sh): at every login/boot it starts Docker, waits for the engine, and brings TaskWA up. Full four-link chain (auto power-on, auto-login, Docker, containers) in docs/UNATTENDED.md.
- **Keep the machine awake** — a sleeping laptop sends no digests. Digests missed by under 6 hours send on wake; missed broadcasts are skipped on purpose.

The one standing risk, stated plainly: TaskWA uses an unofficial WhatsApp gateway. WhatsApp can ban the paired number without notice. Keep volumes modest, keep the hourly cap on, and understand that on a personal number, the ban risk is to your personal account. Your task data is never at risk — only the delivery channel.